

A story for ages 13 to 17

Teenpreneur

One school year, one side hustle, and everything nobody tells
you about money





Teenpreneur

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A story about Laila, Omar, Salma and Aunt Nour, and one school year with a side hustle.

Written for teenagers who want to earn their own money,
and for the adults who cheer them on.

Pictures: needle-felted art made for this book. Fonts: Manrope and Readex Pro (SIL Open Font Licence).

Ideas follow the game Teenpreneur. Not financial or legal advice.

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Before you start

Laila is 15. Her sister’s old laptop dies in the middle of a maths assignment, and a new one costs 18,000 pounds. This book follows her through one school year of designing menus and posters for the shops on her street, with her friends Omar and Salma, and her Aunt Nour, who has run a small print shop for twenty years.

Each scene ends with Nour’s note: one idea, in plain words. At the end of each chapter there is a page of tools to use in your own side hustle this week.

The story comes from Teenpreneur, a free game where you run a side hustle week by week and keep your grades up. Read a chapter, then play the year.

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The first price



Every side hustle starts with something you want, something you can do, and a number you are scared to say out loud.

If you don't put a price on your time, someone else will.
Usually zero.

Aunt Nour

In this chapter



A goal you can divide



A price covers costs and time



Profit is what is left



Count the hours



Rules you write together

600 a week

$$\begin{array}{|c|} \hline 18,000 \\ \hline \text{the laptop (pounds)} \\ \hline \end{array} \div \begin{array}{|c|} \hline 30 \\ \hline \text{school weeks} \\ \hline \end{array} = \begin{array}{|c|} \hline 600 \\ \hline \text{pounds a week} \\ \hline \end{array}$$



The screen went black at 11 at night, halfway through a maths assignment. Laila's sister's laptop was 8 years old, and this time it did not wake up. A good used one cost 18,000 pounds. Laila said the number to Aunt Nour like it was a mountain. Nour took a pen and wrote it on a receipt. "How many weeks in the school year?" About 30. She divided. "Then it is not 18,000. It is 600 a week. Can you find 600 a week?" Laila did not know. But 600 sounded like something you could try.



NOUR'S NOTE · A GOAL YOU CAN DIVIDE

A big number is a wish. The same number divided by the weeks you have is a plan you can check every Friday.



CHAPTER 1 · 2

What is an hour worth?

Uncle Fathi's café on the corner had the same menu since before Laila was born. Laila drew him a new one in her sketchbook. He loved it. "How much?" he asked. "100?" said Laila. Aunt Nour, drinking tea at the back table, raised one eyebrow. Later she asked: how many hours did it take? Six, with the changes. And printing it properly? 150 pounds. "So you would pay 50 pounds for the honour of working six hours," Nour said. Laila went back the next day and said 450. Uncle Fathi said yes before she finished the sentence.



NOUR'S NOTE · A PRICE COVERS COSTS AND TIME

Add up what the job costs you in money, then put a fair value on your hours. The first price people say is usually what they are scared of, not what the work is worth.

The first profit

$$\begin{array}{ccc}
 \boxed{450} & - & \boxed{150} = \boxed{300} \\
 \text{Uncle Fathi paid} & & \text{printing} & & \text{profit}
 \end{array}$$



Uncle Fathi paid in crisp notes and gave her a free mango juice. Laila walked home with 450 pounds and the feeling of being rich. At the print shop, Nour took 150 back for the lamination, and did not give her a family discount. “You are a customer now. Customers pay.” Laila opened a notebook and wrote two columns: in and out. 450 in. 150 out. 300 left. Half of a week’s target, from one menu. She drew a small star next to it.



NOUR’S NOTE · PROFIT IS WHAT IS LEFT

The money that comes in is not yours yet. Take out what you spent to do the job, and only the rest counts towards the goal.



CHAPTER 1 · 4

Omar's screwdriver

Omar from the fourth floor fixed phones. Everyone knew it, because he did it for almost nothing. A cracked screen, 200 pounds, and he spent 170 on the part. He showed Laila his tiny screwdrivers like a surgeon. “I make 30 pounds an hour,” she said, after counting. He laughed, then stopped laughing. “I never counted the hours.” They sat on the stairs and worked out a real price for a screen: the part, his time, and a little for the screens he breaks while learning. It came to 400. “Nobody will pay that,” said Omar. That week, 3 people did.



NOUR'S NOTE · COUNT THE HOURS

Divide what you keep by the hours you worked. If the number is smaller than a part-time job, the price is too low, not the work too slow.



CHAPTER 1 · 5

The deal at home

At dinner Laila announced she had a business. Her mother put down her spoon. “And school?” Laila had expected this. She had written a page, the way Nour told her to. One: school comes first, always. Two: no work after 10 at night. Three: if her grades drop below 70, the business pauses until they come back. Four: every new client, Mum knows who they are. Her father read it twice and signed the bottom, and asked for a menu for his office. Her mother signed too, and stuck the page on the fridge with a magnet shaped like a lemon.



NOUR'S NOTE · RULES YOU WRITE TOGETHER

Parents worry less about what they can see. A short written deal about school, sleep and safety turns a fight into a plan.

Tools for week 1

1. Your goal, divided

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=

the goal

weeks

a week

2. Before you say a price

- ☐ What will this job cost me in materials, printing or travel?

- ☐ How many hours will it really take, with changes?

- ☐ What does similar work cost around here?

- ☐ Will I still be happy with this price after the third change?

3. The deal at home: write your four rules

The full book

This was chapter 1 of 8. The whole school year, with every chapter's tools, is in the printed book.

1	The first price	Week 1
2	First customers	Week 4
3	Exam season	Week 9
4	The partner	Week 13
5	The comment	Week 16
6	Late nights	Week 19
7	Trust	Week 24
8	The end of the year	Week 30

Laila needs 18,000 pounds by the end of the school year. She has a sketchbook, a friend who fixes phones, an aunt with opinions, and a mother who signed a contract on the fridge. A story about pricing your time, saying no, staying safe, keeping your grades, and the first money you ever earned yourself.



Play the game free

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English and Arabic · No account

